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Et tu, Brute? How a Republic Dies

Et tu, Brute? — Julius Caesar and the fragile Roman Republic

Daughter

'Et tu, Brute?' Dad, was Brutus a hero or a traitor?

Dad

That question has outlived him by two thousand years. Tonight we watch a republic die - slowly, then all at once.

Rome, before the emperors. A state built so no single man could rule it all.

Dad

The Republic shared power - elected officials, a Senate, popular assemblies. They'd thrown out their kings and swore: never again one master.

Daughter

So it was like... a democracy with rules?



Res Publica - 'the public thing.' Power on loan, never owned.

Caesar

I gave Rome Gaul, order, and glory. Let the timid Senate debate while I win. History thanks the strong hand, not the slow committee.

Roman People

Caesar! Caesar feeds us! Caesar wins!

(환호성)

(위엄있는)

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Caesar (I): Rome bled for a century. I am the cure it is too proud to swallow.

Caesar

The Senate orders me to disband my army and come home powerless. I cross this river instead.



49 BCE. The Rubicon. A general brings his private army against his own state. There is no crossing back.

광기의 로마

Roman People

Dictator for life! Long life to Caesar!

Senate

Banners with one man's face. Statues. 'For life.' We fought kings for this?



Victory made him beloved - and permanent. Dictator perpetuo. To some, freedom. To others, a crown by another name.

계속...

Daughter

But the people LOVED him. If they voted for him, isn't that democracy?

Dad

Careful. A crowd cheering one man is not the same as a people keeping their rules. That's the whole trap.

질문?

생각...



Dad: Popularity can hollow out a republic from the inside - with applause.

A comic book illustration depicting a tense moment between two men in ancient Rome. On the left, Cassius, with a dark beard and intense expression, wears a yellow tunic and a dark cloak. On the right, Brutus, with a lighter beard and green eyes, wears a white tunic and a red cloak. They are standing in a grand hall with tall columns. In the background, other figures in Roman attire are visible. The scene is lit with a cool, blueish light, creating a dramatic atmosphere.

Cassius

While we talk of laws, he becomes a god with an army. I need a name Rome trusts. I need you, Brutus.

Brutus

You mix Rome's freedom with your own grudges, Cassius.

Cassius (I): Ideals are lovely. But someone must count the swords. Brutus is the noble face the people will forgive.

Brutus

I love Caesar the man. But I love the Republic more than any man. If one Roman may become king, then no Roman is free.



Brutus (I): Not from hate. From duty. Rome must outlive her heroes - even the one I call friend.

Calpurnia

I dreamed your blood on the marble. Stay home today. Please.

Caesar

If I hide from every whisper of fear, I am not Caesar. The Senate waits.

콰악...
*KRA-KOOM

화덕

THUD

Calpurnia: Power costs the house first. I am the fear he cannot afford to hear.

Senate

A petition, Caesar - just here, come closer.

Caesar

Speak, then. I have a Rome to govern.

저리가!

막아!

막아!

위험해

The Ides of March, 44 BCE. They meet in Pompey's hall - the Senate house was under repair. The circle closes.

Caesar
You too, Brutus?

Brutus
For Rome, old friend. For Rome.

The wound was in the body of one man - and in the body of the state.



Brutus

Romans! The tyrant is dead - the Republic lives again! Rejoice!

Senate

...silence.

Brutus (II): I assumed they'd cheer liberty. That was my blindest wound of all.

Antony

They call themselves honorable men. Look - he left his gardens to YOU, the people. Is THIS your reward to him?

Roman People

Traitors! Burn the murderers' houses!

가이사르의

유언!!



Antony: Their daggers had reasons. I have his cloak, his will, and your grief. Watch which one moves a crowd.

Cassius

We killed the man and multiplied the war.
The crowd never wanted a republic. It
wanted a father.

Brutus

What have we freed, Cassius? Only more
knives.

A moment of
hesitation...

The senate
is lost.

Find the
conspirators!

...Is this the ruin
I have brought?

No liberty returned. Only civil war - and soon, an emperor named Augustus
to end all doubt.

Daughter

So Brutus wasn't a hero OR a traitor. He was... wrong about people.

박

흠...

Dad

He thought one dagger could restart freedom. Freedom isn't a machine you reset by killing a man. Political violence usually just opens the next war.

The strongman fell. The Republic did not rise. That gap is the lesson.

역사의 한 페이지

(A Page of History)

Dad

Watch for the pattern, not the toga:
banners with one face, 'for the people'
from every mouth, rules bent for a winner
everyone loves.

Dad

And the institutions we refuse to hollow
out. Heroes and knives don't save
republics. Awake citizens do.

Daughter

So freedom isn't the hero. It's... us
staying awake.

역사의
턱북혀지
(학자 리치 웡버)



Rome fell into empire not in one stab, but in a thousand cheers.
Democracies die when we stop guarding the rules - and stay saved when we
don't.